

Mahdi Salem

Lead Data Engineer · Power BI Architect · Operational Intelligence Leader

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Turning operational complexity into decision intelligence.

I don't build dashboards for people to look at — I build them for people to see with. As a Lead Data Engineer and Power BI Developer, I transform fragmented operational data into trusted decision systems that reveal patterns, expose risks, clarify interdependencies, and guide measurable action across production, quality, and executive operations — on demand, without added overhead. I lead and mentor a cross-functional team of developers and data engineers, while drawing on a broader background in organizational development and executive-level strategy to keep the platform tightly connected to the decisions it needs to serve.

Core Competencies

Power BI & DAX

Microsoft Fabric & OneLake

Databricks (Delta Lake, Spark)

Azure Data Factory & Synapse

PowerApps & Power Automate

Data Quality & Governance

Python / SQL

Process Re-engineering

Team Leadership & Mentoring

Stakeholder & Executive Alignment

Data & BI Leadership Experience

Lead Data Engineer & Power BI Developer Bombardier Aviation

2018 – Present

Mississauga, ON

- Architected multi-factory, multi-country SSIS ETL pipelines and 150+ Power BI / PowerApps solutions supporting Production Andon, QA, and PMO teams.
- Built a Data Quality KPI framework reconciling SAP, MES, and local production data, improving shop-floor data integrity company-wide.
- Integrated Azure Data Lake and Power BI Premium capacity monitoring, reducing resource overhead while preserving query performance.
- Designed and launched a full-stack Production Tracking web application (.NET / Angular) for volatile, non-standard assembly work, plus a Django-based attendance system with an admin/supervisor dashboard.
- Led and coached a team of up to 4 developers and data engineers, defining roles, planning workload, and building 10+ rapid-response VBA and PowerApps tools that removed manual, cross-departmental work.
- Set reporting standards under the Bombardier Operational Excellence initiative, creating reusable templates adopted across teams.

Logistics & Process Digitization Lead

2015 – 2018

AAA Canada / Anjaz Group — Aerospace & Transportation

Greater Toronto Area, ON

- Engineered a Production Tracking application and a Logistic Cage/Kanban system that gave real-time visibility into kit status and job readiness, removing recurring line stoppages.
- Built a Manpower Mapping tool to separate touch vs. non-touch labor, cutting non-value-added idle time on the shop floor.
- Automated Daily Management Meeting and Rapid Non-Conformance reporting, lifting reporting efficiency by 200% and reducing generation time from hours to minutes.
- Consolidated scope-of-work, over-issue, and non-conformance records into one database, unifying regional standards across FAL, buyers, and vendors.

Leadership & Consulting Background

Director, Systems & Methods Development / Business Technology and Excellence

2013 – 2015

Persia Oil and Gas Drilling Co. of Qeshm

Tehran, Iran

- Built an enterprise process map and documentation framework from the ground up, enabling the company's first drilling project to launch in 3 months.
- Ran work-study and standardization programs that delivered a third-party-verified 15% productivity gain and led the company's shift to BPM-based systems.

VP, Marketing & International Affairs / Manager, Systems & Method Engineering

2011 – 2013

Oil Exploration Operation Company

Tehran, Iran

- Promoted to VP after repositioning Marketing into the company's core bidding and proposal engine; led 31 process-improvement projects in the first 30 days of the prior role.
- Directed a sensitive three-phase organizational downsizing while protecting core capability and key talent.

Lead Business Consultant

2001 – 2012

Independent — Various Companies

Tehran, Iran

- Directed 30+ consulting engagements in Strategic Planning, Business Process Re-engineering, TQM, and Six Sigma across diverse industries, authoring 100+ winning proposals and RFQs.

Education

Master of Business Management, Marketing

Allameh Tabatabaie University, 1996 – 1999

Bachelor's Degree, Insurance Management

Business Analytics

Duke University, 2016 – 2017

Certifications

Microsoft Certified: Power BI Data Analyst Associate

Microsoft Certified: Data Analyst Associate

Microsoft Certified: Power Platform App Maker Associate

Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Fundamentals

Microsoft Certified: Power Platform Fundamentals

Microsoft Office Specialist: Excel 2016 Expert

Full career history, technical skill inventory, and complete certification list available on request or in the extended CV.